

ICT2217

Network Security

Lab 1.5 Notes:

DHCP Attacks and Defense



Lab Exercise 1.5

1–4

DHCP starvation and DHCP server spoofing attacks, which can lead to DNS server spoofing and website spoofing attacks

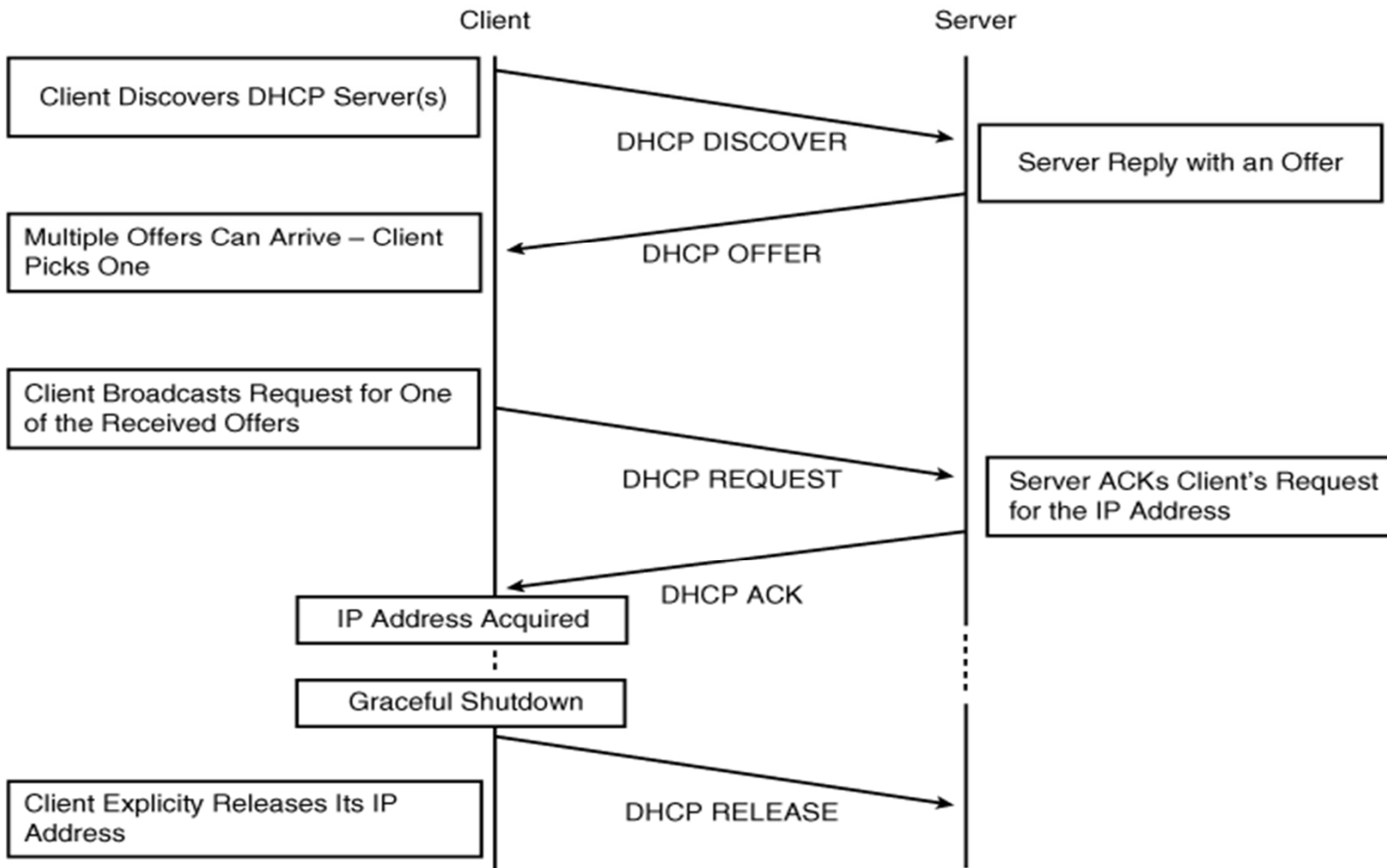
5

Defense:

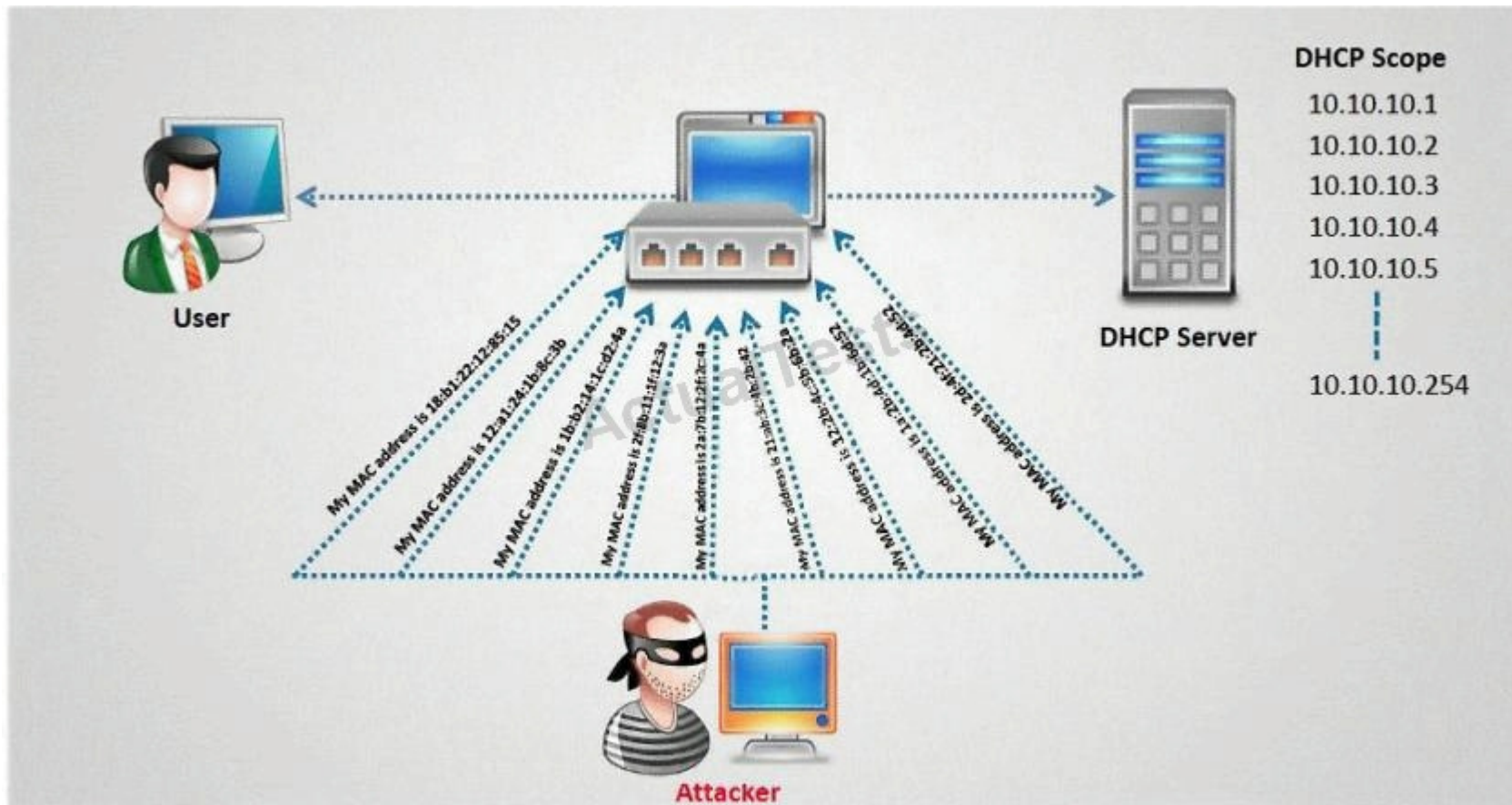
- Configure DHCP snooping in switches

In ICT1013, you have learned **DHCP** (**D**ynamic **H**ost **C**ontrol **P**rotocol) for hosts to automatically obtain **IP** address, default gateway, **DNS**, etc. in order to function.

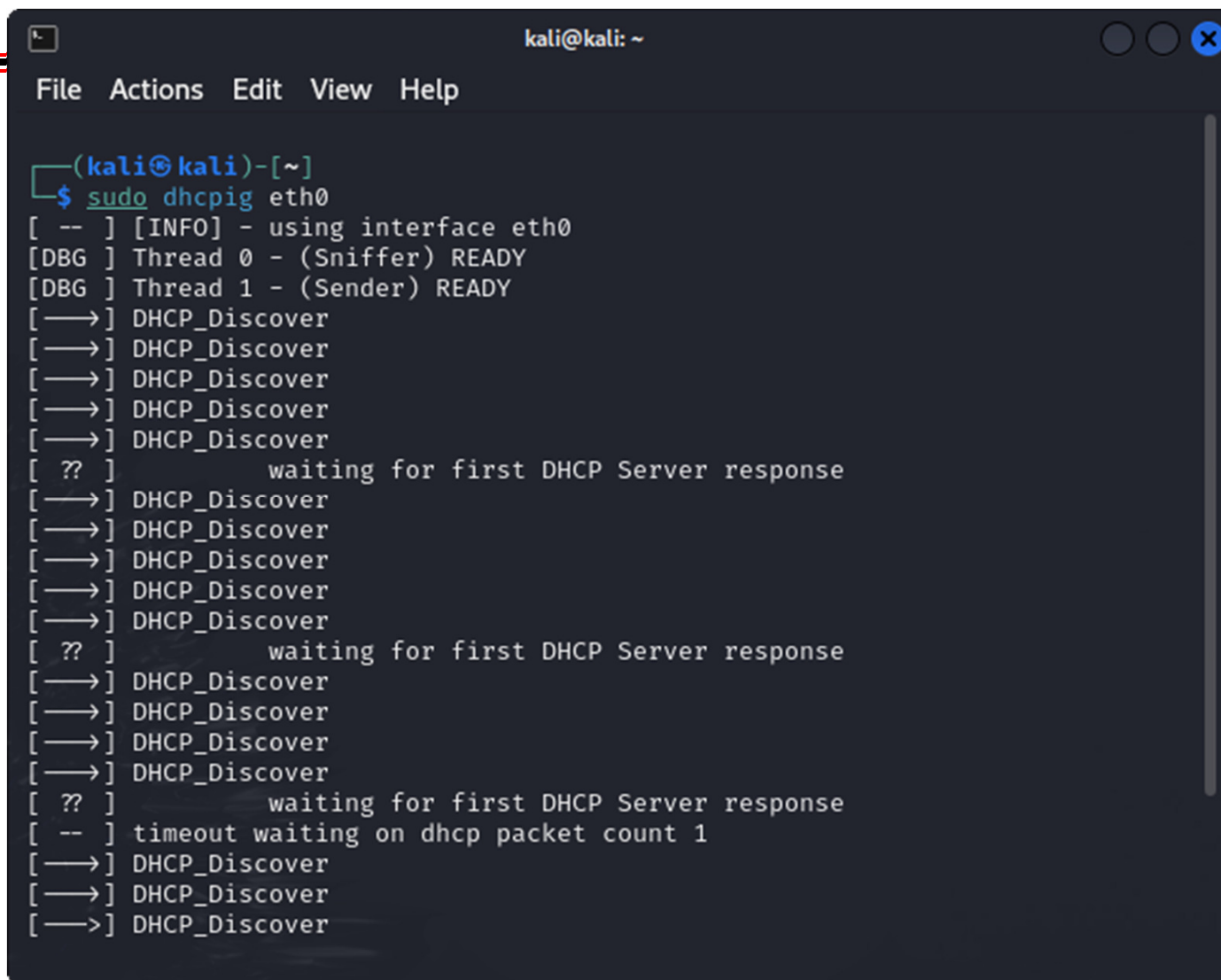
Initial DHCP Exchange



Unfortunately, **DHCP** has no security! An obvious attack is **starvation/exhaustion/DoS attack** where an attacker generates many DHCP Discover messages to seize all IP addresses.



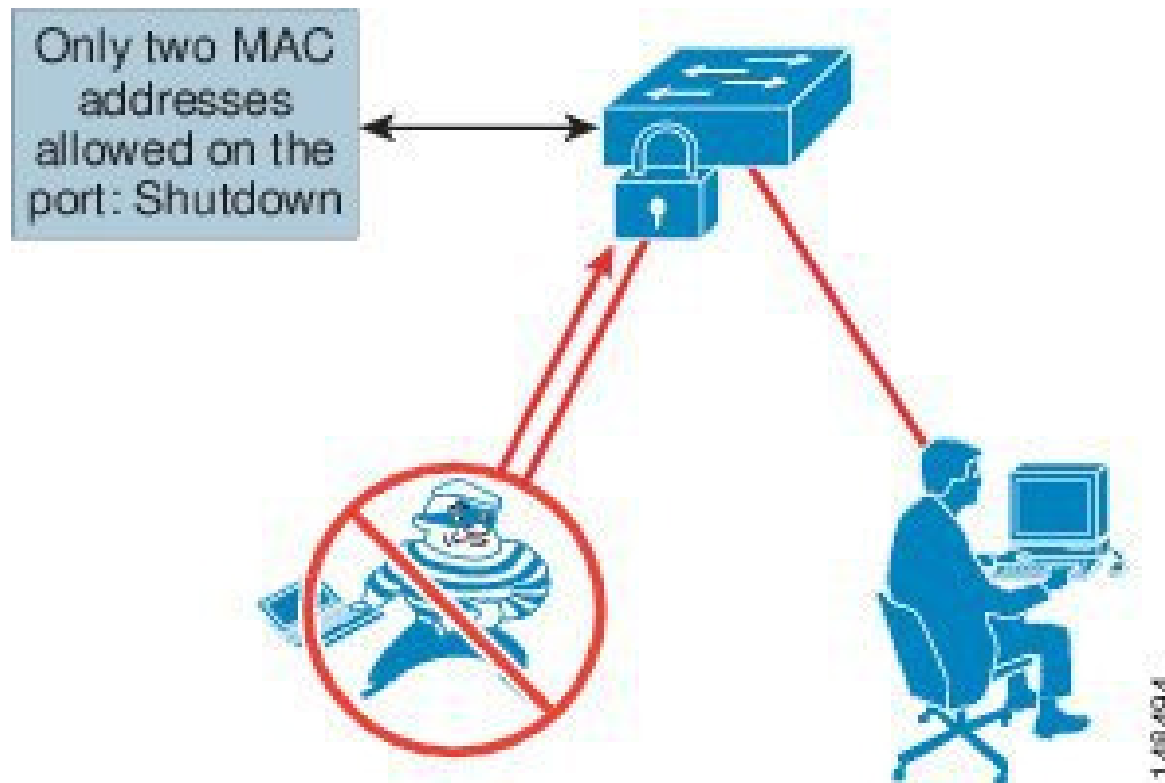
An example of conducting **DHCP starvation attack** using **DHCPig** in Kali Linux.



```
kali@kali: ~  
File Actions Edit View Help  
  
(kali@kali)-[~]  
$ sudo dhcpiG eth0  
[ -- ] [INFO] - using interface eth0  
[DBG ] Thread 0 - (Sniffer) READY  
[DBG ] Thread 1 - (Sender) READY  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[ ?? ]      waiting for first DHCP Server response  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[ ?? ]      waiting for first DHCP Server response  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[ ?? ]      waiting for first DHCP Server response  
[ -- ] timeout waiting on dhcp packet count 1  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[—>] DHCP_Discover  
[—>] DHCP_Discover
```

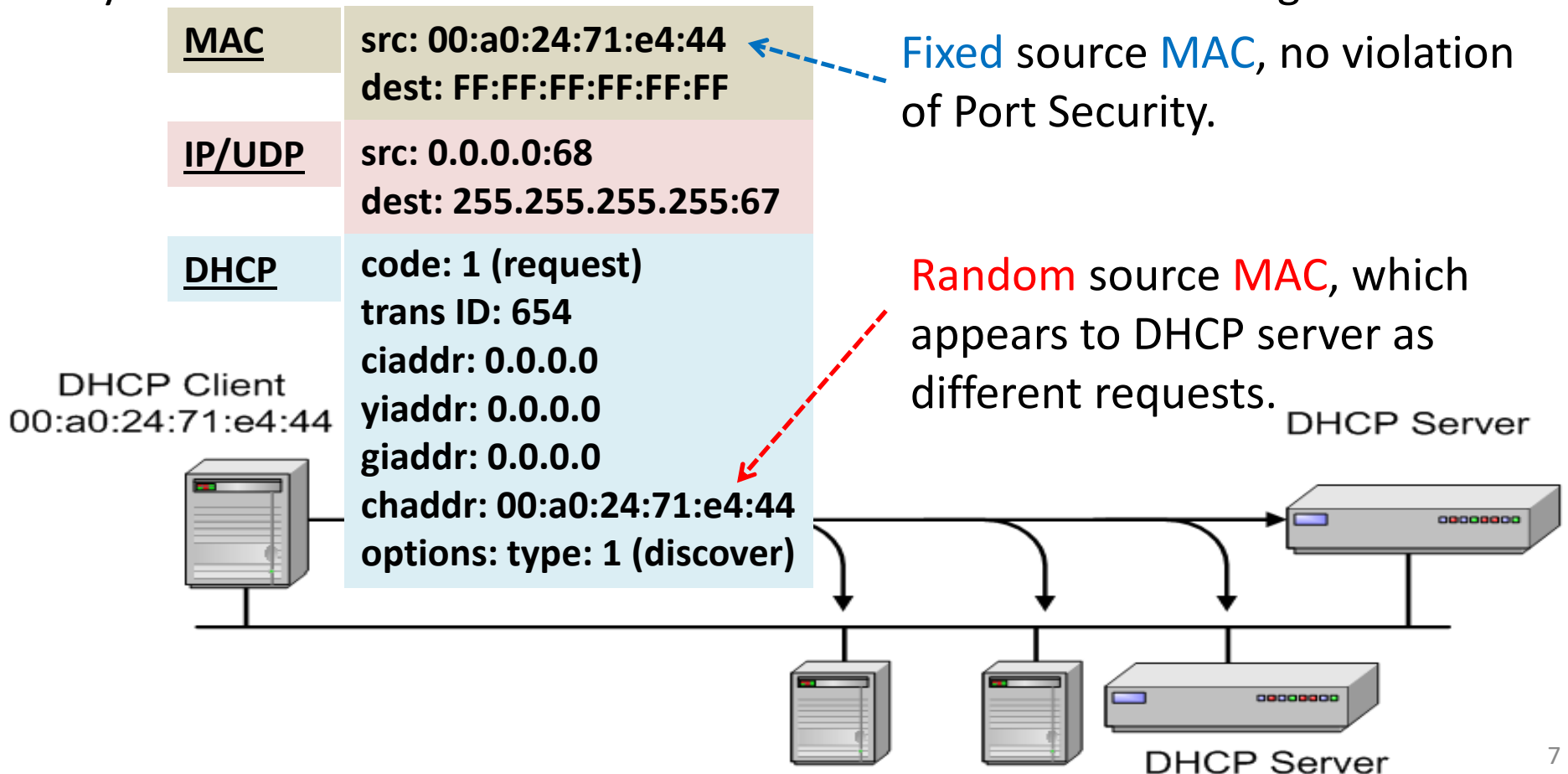
Do you think **Port Security** is an effective defense to counter **DHCP starvation attack**?

Port Security limits the MAC addresses allowed on a port, which can prevent an attacker from sending many **DHCP Discover** messages with different **MAC** addresses.

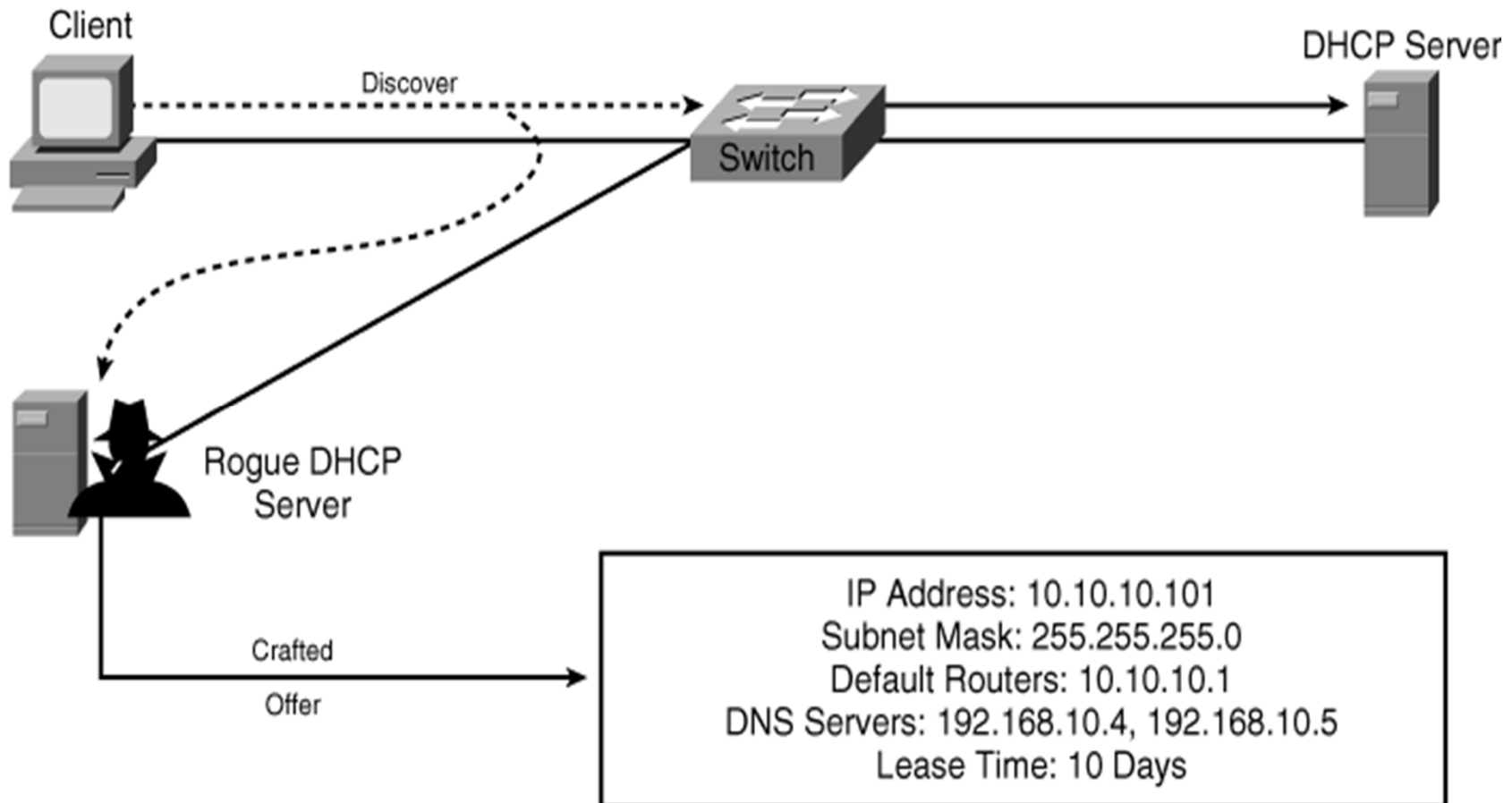


Unfortunately, an **attacker** can still generate many **DHCPDiscover** messages without violating Port Security as follow: (This shows why you need to know **details**!)

Remember **DHCP** is at **application layer**, i.e. the lower layers are removed by the OS before DHCP server receives the final DHCP message.



After DHCP starvation attack, an attacker may follow up with **DHCP server spoofing attack** which is to set up a **rogue DHCP server** to respond to users DHCP messages.



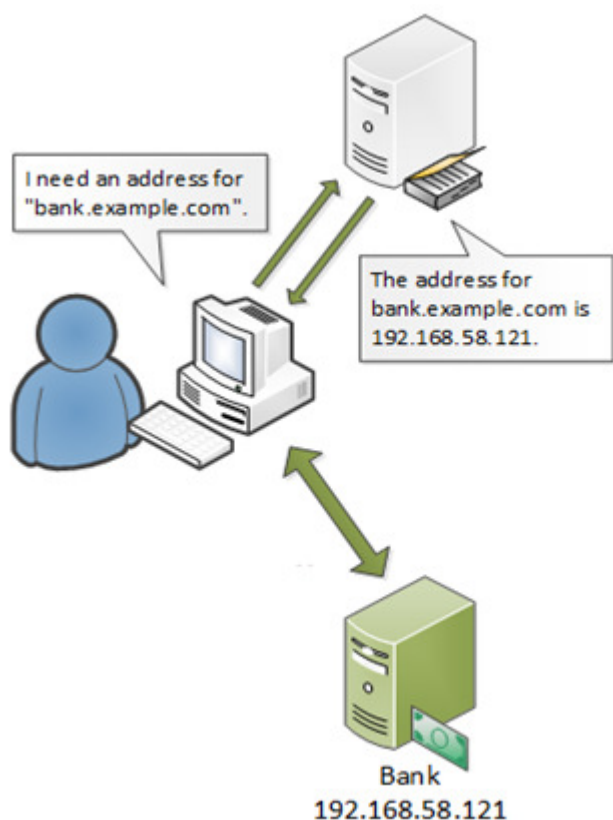
The **Metasploit** tool in Kali Linux has a DHCP module which can be used to run a **rogue DHCP server**.

```
kali@kali: ~  
File Actions Edit View Help  
  
(kali@kali)-[~]  
$ msfconsole  
  
# cowsay++  
  
< metasploit >  
  
  \  (oo)_____  
   \  (__)_____)\  
      ||-----|| *  
  
=[ metasploit v6.0.30-dev  
+ -- --=[ 2099 exploits - 1129 auxiliary - 3  
+ -- --=[ 592 payloads - 45 encoders - 10 n  
+ -- --=[ 7 evasion  
  
Metasploit tip: Search can apply complex filters  
search cve:2009 type:exploit, see all the filters  
with help search  
  
msf6 > use auxiliary/server/dhcp  
msf6 auxiliary(server/dhcp) > |
```

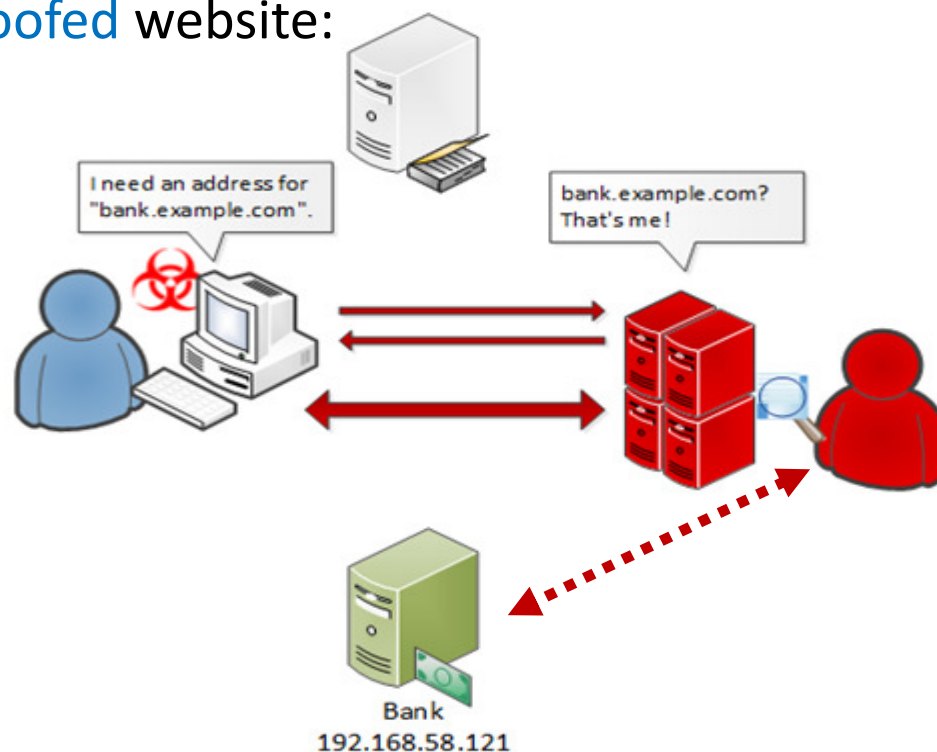
```
kali@kali: ~  
File Actions Edit View Help  
  
msf6 > use auxiliary/server/dhcp  
msf6 auxiliary(server/dhcp) > set SRVHOST 192.168.1.11  
SRVHOST => 192.168.1.11  
msf6 auxiliary(server/dhcp) > set NETMASK 255.255.255.0  
NETMASK => 255.255.255.0  
msf6 auxiliary(server/dhcp) > set DHCPPIPCOUNT 192.168.1.100  
DHCPPIPCOUNT => 192.168.1.100  
msf6 auxiliary(server/dhcp) > set DHCPPIPCOUNT 192.168.1.199  
DHCPPIPCOUNT => 192.168.1.199  
msf6 auxiliary(server/dhcp) > set ROUTER 192.168.1.11  
ROUTER => 192.168.1.11  
msf6 auxiliary(server/dhcp) > set DNSSERVER 192.168.1.11  
DNSSERVER => 192.168.1.11  
msf6 auxiliary(server/dhcp) > show options  
  
Module options (auxiliary/server/dhcp):  
  
Name          Current Setting  Required  Description  
-----  
BROADCAST      no               no        The broadcast address to send to  
DHCPPIPCOUNT    192.168.1.199    no        The last IP to give out  
DHCPPIPCOUNT    192.168.1.100    no        The first IP to give out  
DNSSERVER       192.168.1.11     no        The DNS server IP address  
DOMAINNAME      no               no        The optional domain name to assign  
FILENAME        no               no        The optional filename of a tftp bo  
ot server  
HOSTNAME        no               no        The optional hostname to assign  
HOSTSTART       no               no        The optional host integer counter  
NETMASK         255.255.255.0    yes       The netmask of the local subnet  
ROUTER          192.168.1.11     no        The router IP address  
SRVHOST         192.168.1.11     yes       The IP of the DHCP server  
  
Auxiliary action:  
  
Name          Description  
-----  
Service       Run DHCP server  
  
msf6 auxiliary(server/dhcp) > run|
```

With DHCP server spoofing attack, an attacker can now easily direct users to **rogue DNS server** to mistranslate domain name to IP address to lead them to the **spoofed website**!

Before attack:



After **DHCP server spoofing** attack directing user to **rogue DNS server** and then **spoofed website**:

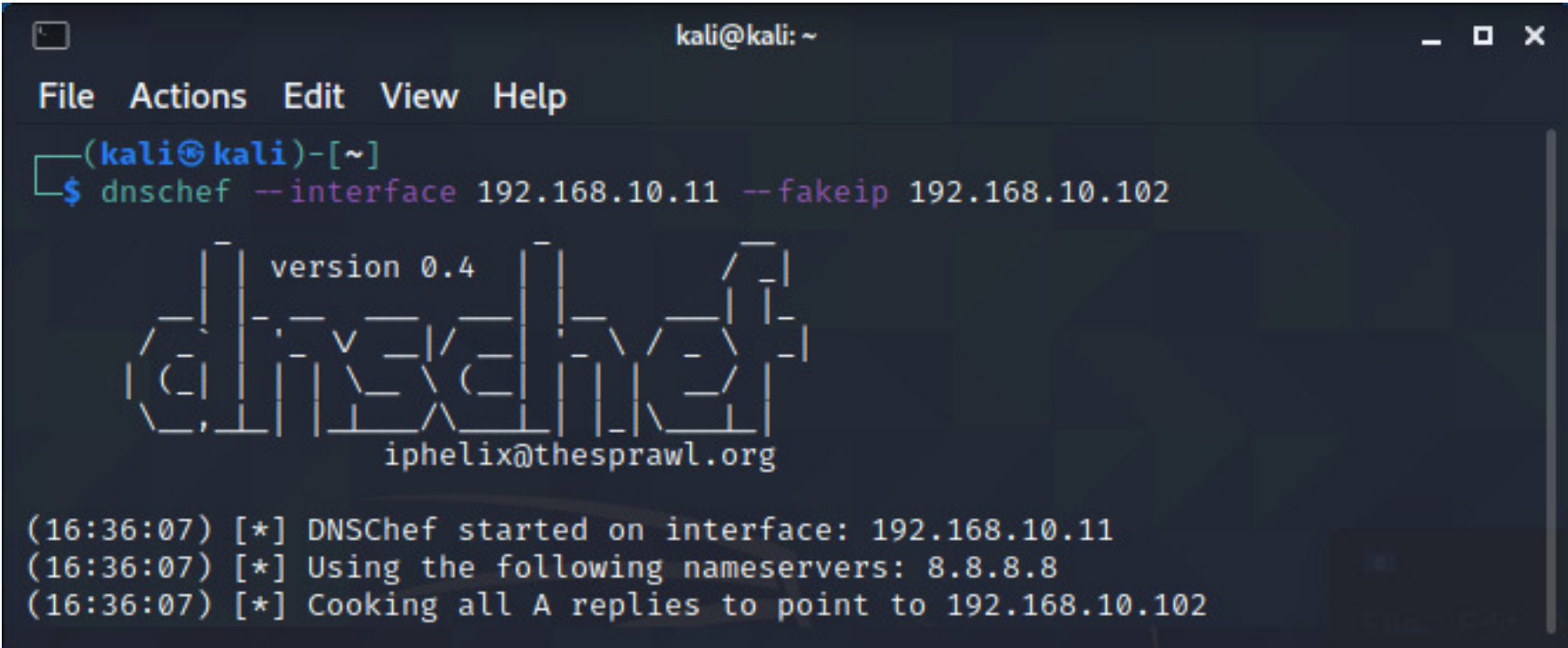


An **attacker** may then use the information obtained to **masquerade** as the authorized user to login to the real website!

The **DNSChef** tool in Kali Linux can be used to run the **rogue DNS server**.

Refer to <https://www.kali.org/tools/dnscchef> on dnscchef usage

e.g.: To start DNS server to listen at interface 192.168.10.11 and mis-translating all DNS replies to **attacker's fake IP** address 192.168.10.102



```
kali@kali: ~  
File Actions Edit View Help  
(kali@kali)-[~]  
$ dnscchef --interface 192.168.10.11 --fakeip 192.168.10.102  
  
version 0.4  
dnscchef  
iphelix@thesprawl.org  
  
(16:36:07) [*] DNSChef started on interface: 192.168.10.11  
(16:36:07) [*] Using the following nameservers: 8.8.8.8  
(16:36:07) [*] Cooking all A replies to point to 192.168.10.102
```

To prevent **DHCP starvation and spoofing attacks**, a defence called **DHCP snooping** is developed which enables a switch to perform **deep-packet inspections** of higher layers.

Enable **DHCP snooping** in the switch and then specify the required VLANs as follows:

```
Switch(config)# ip dhcp snooping
Switch(config)# ip dhcp snooping vlan vlan-id [vlan-id]
```

Configure **DHCP snooping MAC address verification** to verify layer 2 source MAC **matches** application layer DHCP client hardware address (chaddr), and **drop if different**.

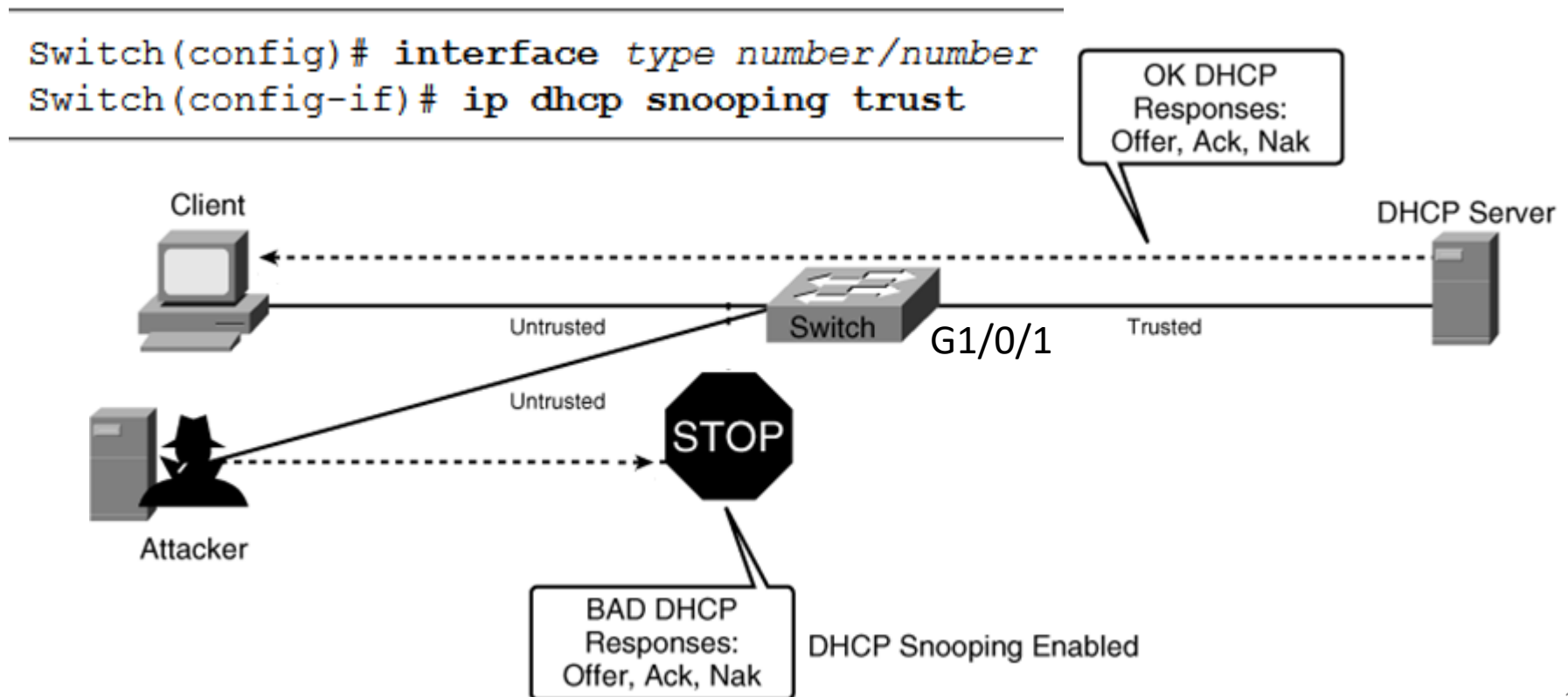
```
Switch(config)# ip dhcp snooping verify mac-address
```

For **each port**, **DHCP snooping rate-limiting** (from 1 – 2048 DHCP pps) can also be configured. If **exceeded**, the port is put into **err-disabled** state.

```
Switch(config)# interface type number/number
Switch(config-if)# ip dhcp snooping limit rate rate
```

When **DHCP snooping** is enabled, **all ports** are by default **untrusted** which will **not allow** DHCP Offer and DHCP Ack messages, thus making it impossible to run rogue DHCP server.

To support DHCP servers, the **ports** connected to the **authorized DHCP servers** must be manually configured to be **trusted** as follows:



An example of configuring **DHCP snooping** on a switch and verifying the status:

```
Switch(config)# ip dhcp snooping
Switch(config)# ip dhcp snooping vlan 10
Switch(config)# interface range gigabitethernet 1/0/35 - 36
Switch(config-if)# ip dhcp snooping limit rate 3
Switch(config-if)# interface gigabitethernet 1/0/1
Switch(config-if)# ip dhcp snooping trust
```

authentic DHCP server
at interface G1/0/1

```
Switch# show ip dhcp snooping
Switch DHCP snooping is enabled
DHCP snooping is configured on following VLANs:
10
```

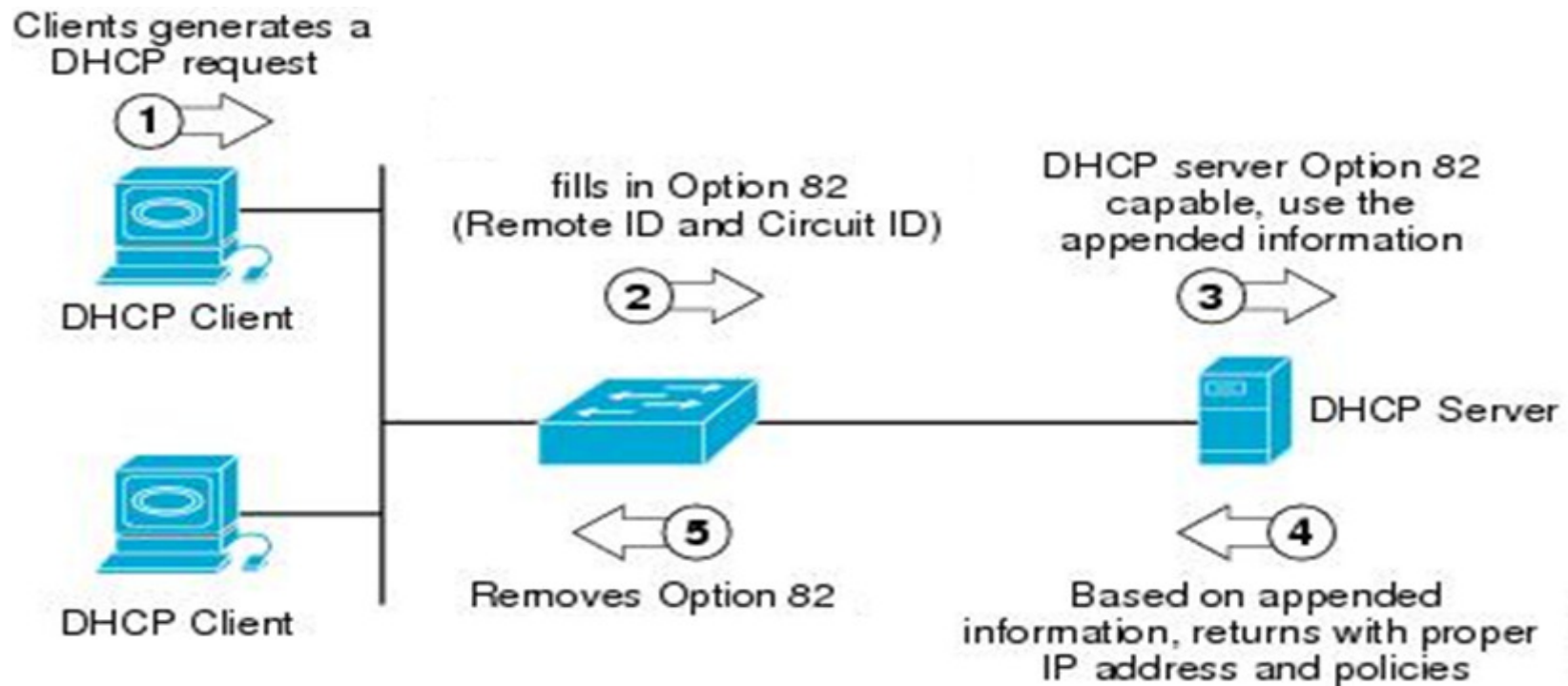
Insertion of option 82 is enabled

Interface	Trusted	Rate limit (pps)
-----	-----	-----
GigabitEthernet1/0/35	no	3
GigabitEthernet1/0/36	no	3
GigabitEthernet1/0/1	yes	unlimited

Switch#

Note that by default, a switch enabled with **DHCP snooping** will automatically insert an **option-82 (relay agent information option)** field into the original **DHCP** messages sent by the client.

The **option-82** field contains **circuit ID** (containing VLAN and port number) and **remote ID** (containing base MAC address) of the switch which provides information about location of client that sends the DHCPDiscover message.



However, the switch is not a relay agent, so the relay agent IP address (giaddr) is zeros while option-82 agent field is being inserted as shown in example DHCPDiscover message below:

snoop3.pcapng [Wireshark 1.12.0 (v1.12.0-0-g4fab41a from master-1.12)]

File Edit View Go Capture Analyze Statistics Telephony Tools Internals Help

Filter: Expression... Clear Apply Save

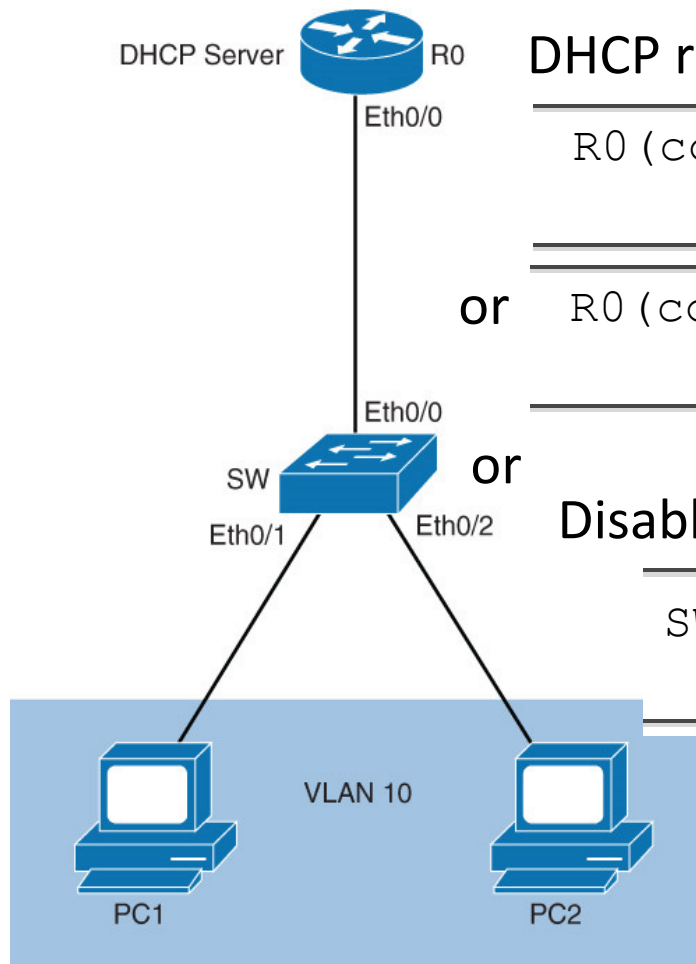
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Length	Info
38	39.988710000	0.0.0.0	255.255.255.255	DHCP	349	DHCP Discover - Transaction
39	39.989036000	192.168.10.1	192.168.10.13	DHCP	348	DHCP Offer - Transaction
41	39.999528000	0.0.0.0	255.255.255.255	DHCP	374	DHCP Request - Transaction
42	39.999530000	192.168.10.1	192.168.10.13	DHCP	348	DHCP ACK - Transaction

Client IP address: 0.0.0.0 (0.0.0.0)
Your (client) IP address: 0.0.0.0 (0.0.0.0)
Next server IP address: 0.0.0.0 (0.0.0.0)
Relay agent IP address: 0.0.0.0 (0.0.0.0)
Client MAC address: 34:17:eb:b4:a9:19 (34:17:eb:b4:a9:19)
Client hardware address padding: 00000000000000000000
Server host name not given
Boot file name not given
Magic cookie: DHCP
+ Option: (53) DHCP Message Type (Discover)
+ Option: (61) Client identifier
+ Option: (12) Host Name
+ Option: (60) Vendor class identifier
+ Option: (55) Parameter Request List
+ Option: (82) Agent Information Option
Length: 18
+ Option 82 Suboption: (1) Agent Circuit ID
+ Option 82 Suboption: (2) Agent Remote ID
+ Option: (255) End

Frame (frame), 349 bytes Packets: Profile: Default

Unfortunately, a DHCP packet with **option-82** but **relay agent IP** address (giaddr) **zeros** will by default be **discarded** by the next receiving DHCP relay agent/router.

To resolve this problem, configure either:



DHCP router to trust DHCP messages:

```
R0(config)# ip dhcp relay information
trust-all
```

or

```
R0(config-if)# ip dhcp relay information
trusted
```

or

Disable option-82 on a DHCP snooping switch:

```
SW(config)# no ip dhcp snooping
information option
```

To support **DHCP snooping**, the switch also maintains a **binding table** containing DHCP assigned **addresses** for **untrusted ports** which can be used to defend other attacks (next exercises).

The **DHCP snooping binding table** is updated automatically:

- Upon seeing **DHCPACK**, new entry is **added** into binding table.
- Upon seeing **DHCPNack**, **DHCPRelease** or **DHCPDecline**, corresponding entry is **removed**.

```
SW# show ip dhcp snooping binding
```

MacAddress	IpAddress	Lease(sec)	Type	VLAN	Interface
-----	-----	-----	-----	----	-----
00:24:13:47:AF:C2	192.168.1.4	85858	dhcp-snooping	10	GigabitEthernet1/0/35
00:24:13:47:7D:B1	192.168.1.5	85859	dhcp-snooping	10	GigabitEthernet1/0/36
Total number of bindings: 2					
